

VÉLØ CASH RUN — 2026-05-03

STANDOUT PICKS — ★★★ and ★★ only

OR history: pos/rating (latest first) | TS history: pos/TS/going (latest first)

NMK

NMK 2.55 1m 6f (Class 2) Last 9 outings(pos,rating,beaten/winning distance)

RACE VERDICT:** There has been so much to like about topweight Subsequent but most of it has been delivered on good to soft or soft ground. He has big-race entries and still needs plenty of respect but it might be best to turn elsewhere if the rain has not arrived in significant quantity. Align The Stars (second ch PD Pick: **Charging Thunder** / TS Pick: **Align The Stars

★★★ **Charging Thunder** [9] — OR 90 vs BWL 95 (-5) | ? / Luke Morris | Form: 6-7502 | Conv: 0.953 OR (last 6): $\frac{2}{92}$ $\frac{1}{92}$ 0/96 $\frac{6}{96}$ $\frac{7}{95}$ $\frac{5}{95}$ TS (last 6): 1/90sd -/79gf 6/87sd 7/82ss 5/65sd -/47sd Signals: PD✓ Spotlight: *Had underwhelming hurdle and AW campaigns before his second of five when returned to Flat turf at Beverley (2m) 18 days ago; this demands markedly better and his 2024 and 2025 turf records aren't that persuasive.*

★★ **Align The Stars** [5] — OR 96 vs BWL 99 (-3) | ? / Daniel Muscutt | Form: 8404-1 | Conv: 0.823 OR (last 6): $\frac{7}{99}$ $\frac{5}{99}$ $\frac{7}{98}$ $\frac{8}{96}$ $\frac{4}{94}$ 0/94 TS (last 6): - 7/72s - 4/45g -/90gs 4/98sd Signals: TS✓ Spotlight: *Thereabouts on occasions in 2025, crept down the weights and broke his losing run in clearcut style when he reappeared five weeks ago wearing restored cheekpieces in the Queen's Prize at Kempton (2m, AW); back up 4lb but showed plenty of bottle in that win and may have turned a corner.*

SLI

SLI 3.22 1m 5f 190y Last 9 outings(pos, rating, beaten/winning distance)

RACE VERDICT: A big improver over hurdles at this track last year, Cornmarket could be on a good mark for his Flat handicap debut but **YOU MAKE ME SMILE** (nap) has been coming to hand nicely and is chosen to go back-to-back in this race. She has won before in this reapplied headgear and a top apprentice takes the m PD Pick: **Desert Friend** / TS Pick: **Circus Act**

★★ **Haughty** [12] — OR 45 vs BWL 62 (-17) | ? / Alan Casey | Form: 00968- | Conv: 0.890 OR (last 6): $\frac{5}{65}$ $\frac{5}{65}$ $\frac{6}{63}$ 0/62 0/59 $\frac{9}{54}$ TS (last 6): 5/52sd 6/30g -/23gf -/20gy 9/35gy 6/51sd Spotlight: *Best form over 7f/1m, including sole win in Britain as 3yo; stable debut after layoff and not bred for this sort of test.*

★★ **Desert Friend** [8] — OR 52 vs BWL 76 (-24) | ? / Conor Cusack | Form: 690139 | Conv: 0.850 OR (last 6): $\frac{5}{59}$ $\frac{6}{57}$ $\frac{6}{54}$ $\frac{9}{52}$ 0/51 $\frac{1}{48}$ TS (last 6): 6/56sd 6/46sd 9/28sd -/17sd 1/38sd 3/47sd Signals: PD ✓ Spotlight: *Veteran has done a bit of everything and recorded his eighth win when scoring over 2m on AW in March; poor run at Bellewstown last time but that was only a day after being placed at Dundalk; goes well at Ballinrobe and this track isn't dissimilar.*

★★ **Pons Aelius** [7] — OR 55 vs BWL 79 (-24) | ? / Gabriella Hill | Form: /000-8 | Conv: 0.850 OR (last 6): $\frac{4}{69}$ $\frac{4}{68}$ $\frac{2}{67}$ $\frac{7}{67}$ 0/66 0/65 TS (last 6): - 2/64gs 7/45sd -/38sd - -/30g Spotlight: *Donegal yard likes to pick up horses with back-form, often from Britain, and try to rejuvenate them; six-time winner at up to 2m but hasn't been finishing out his races in Ireland and been off a while.*

SLI 4.32 1m 2f 158y Last 9 outings(pos, rating, beaten/winning distance)

RACE VERDICT: Copper Craft holds strong claims following a good recent AW effort over this trip, while *She's Ideal* is another with a strong chance if staying this longer trip. However, the vote goes to **SARANGPUR**, who shaped really well on handicap debut at Gowran and could appreciate this better ground. *Cleopatra*

★★ **Giselles Defence** [1] — OR 60 vs BWL 71 (-11) | ? / Jimmy Dalton | Form: 0-0005 |
Conv: 0.890 OR (last 6): $\frac{8}{74}$ $\frac{4}{74}$ $\frac{7}{73}$ 0/72 0/71 0/67 TS (last 6): 4/63gf 7/24gf -/17sd - - -
Spotlight: *Won four times for Ian Williams on a variety of ground, all at 1m2f; nothing for this yard at big odds until mildly encouraging run at Bellewstown last time; drops in class now and has his ground, worth a market check.*

MULTIPLES

★★★ Picks (1 horses)

- NMK 2.55 Charging Thunder (0.953)
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1 ★★★ picks | 5 ★★ picks